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1. Executive Summary

Context

The humanitarian sector is scaling up anticipatory action (AA), enabling proactive mobilization to get ahead of predictable climate-related shocks and disease outbreaks through robust forecasting (triggers), pre-agreed activities, and pre-arranged funding. This approach has proven effective, dignified, cost-efficient, and protective of development gains.

Nigeria faces recurrent and destructive flooding. In 2025, floods affected more than 400,000 people in 25 States across Nigeria, with 232 people losing their lives. In 2024, floods displaced 1.2 million people, destroyed 116,000 homes, critical infrastructure and 1.4 million hectares of farmland (an estimated loss of 1.1 million tons and \$1 billion, enough to feed 13 million people). This is while people were still reeling from devastating floods in 2022 which had displaced 4 million people and destroyed 600,000 hectares of farmland.

This document presents the collective framework for flood anticipatory action in Nigeria. It entails coordinated packages of assistance planned to be delivered to people at risk of riverine floods in Nigeria across seven local government areas (LGAs) – Fufure, Yola South, Yola North, Girei, Demsa, Numan, and Lamurde – along the Benue River in Adamawa State, an area prone to recurrent flooding. The framework was developed through a participatory process of humanitarian partners and the Inter-Sector Coordination Group who formed a Core Anticipatory Action Group, coordinated by OCHA, under the overall leadership of the Resident and Humanitarian Coordinator (RC/HC) and in collaboration with the government of Nigeria.

The financing

This framework pre-arranges US \$6 million in pooled-fund financing – \$5 million from the UN's Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF) and \$1 million from the Nigeria Humanitarian Fund (NHF). It aims to protect up to 764,864 people in the seven LGAs through timely, targeted multi-sectoral assistance. Payout of the CERF funds will only occur if triggers are reached, indicating a major riverine flood. NHF funds, while prioritizing a river flooding event, have further flexibility to be reprogrammed to a flash flood scenario or regular rapid response to prioritized humanitarian gaps, in case a riverine flood is not predicted.

CERF funding is pre-arranged for one activation within two years of ERC endorsement, while NHF funding has been approved for 2026. Extensions are subject to ERC/advisory board approval. However, this does not preclude additional co-financing from the Government of Nigeria, other humanitarian partners, funds and financial institutions that may alter the pre-arranged amount for 2026. The World Food Programme, for instance, has committed an additional \$2M in co-financing to scale up multi-purpose cash assistance.

The trigger

The trigger mechanism for this framework includes two separate triggers which can be activated independently:

1. **Riverine flooding trigger [action and readiness]:** used to release CERF *and* NHF funding to implement activities in the 7 LGAs along the Benue River in Adamawa state (Fufure, Yola South, Yola North, Girei, Demsa, Numan, and Lamurde).
2. **Flash flooding observational trigger:** used to release *only* NHF funding, as a reprogramming /secondary option, to implement activities in the 4 additional flash-flooding LGAs in the BAY states (Mobbar, Maiduguri, Geidam, Jere)

1. Riverine flooding trigger

The financing and activities in this framework for riverine flooding (Benue River, Adamawa State) are governed by a two-stage trigger mechanism consisting of an action trigger for full activation and a readiness trigger for early pre-positioning.

1.1 Readiness Trigger

The readiness trigger is activated if the GloFAS ensemble mean discharge exceeds 3,132 m³/s at Wuroboki (G5004) within the first 12 days of leadtime of the forecast, or if the GloFAS reanalysis exceeds the same threshold. The readiness trigger has a return period of approximately 1-in-3 years and is designed to fire ahead of the action trigger, enabling pre-positioning before full activation is confirmed. In observed event years it has fired **up to 10 days ahead of the action trigger**.

As occurred in 2012 and 2018, **it is possible that the readiness trigger is not met in advance of the action trigger**.

1.2 Action Trigger

The action trigger is activated if at least 6 of 10 selected Google GRRR gauge stations along the Benue simultaneously exceed their individual 4-year return period thresholds (~1,100–1,117 m³/s per gauge) on the same day. These 10 gauges were selected from the full set of 42 available GloFAS and Google gauges, as those with the highest performance in detecting historical flood events. The overall return period of the action trigger is approximately 1-in-4.5 years. Operationally, the trigger is expected to fire up to 5 days before a 1-in-4 year flood event.

2. Flash flooding trigger (monitoring only)

This framework will also monitor flash flooding to inform reprogramming options for the NHF and other partner-specific early/rapid response mobilization. It will be triggered if: The flood exposure (calculated by overlaying the satellite flood extent with the population distribution) for an LGA exceeds its corresponding threshold, listed below:

- Mobbar: 14,720 people
- Maiduguri: 23,740 people
- Geidam: 5,501 people
- Jere: 103,612 people

Note that due to biases in the flood extent data between geographies, these values do not correspond directly to the number of people impacted and should only be compared to other values from the same LGA. Furthermore, the levels have been set to give an equal probability of triggering in each LGA, with an overall return period of approximately 4 years.

The action plan

The framework will enable humanitarian partners to deliver anticipatory assistance in a coordinated manner. Partners plan to provide multi-purpose cash as well as in-kind assistance and services across agriculture, health, water, sanitation and hygiene - WASH, shelter and non-food items, protection and common services – early warning and joint targeting.

To promote choice and dignity among beneficiaries, and in line with the Inter-Sector Coordination Group's (ISCG) shift to cash-based response, the activities in this framework include various forms of cash assistance. CERF funding will be made available to UN agencies while the NHF funding will exclusively cover national NGO partners, thus strengthening localization. Other partners are invited and encouraged to scale flood anticipatory assistance via geographical alignment, sectoral complementarity, coordinated targeting and coordinated modalities of assistance. All activities in this framework are critical and align with the lifesaving criteria of the 2026 HNRP prioritization and maintain CERF and NHF's lifesaving focus. CERF will provide funding to UN agencies focusing on Food Security, WASH, Health and Shelter-NFI, underpinned by multi-purpose cash assistance (MPCA). Meanwhile, NHF funding plans to focus on common services such as early warning, child protection and gender-based violence (GBV), underpinned by MPCA.

The pre-agreed actions will focus on the following modalities:

- **Communicating risks, engaging with communities, and early warning messaging:** early warnings, community disease surveillance and hygiene messaging.
- **Providing in-kind assistance:** agriculture support (including animal feed, vaccination, protective dikes and drainage systems), emergency medical, dignity and hygiene supplies, and water infrastructure rehabilitation.
- **Provision of MPCA:** Multi-Purpose Cash Assistance (MPCA), aimed at strengthening household-level flood preparedness.
- **Facilitating access to services:** through mobile health clinics, temporary sexual and reproductive health (SRH) camps, water quality measures, referrals for protection needs, and disease surveillance and prevention services.

Learning

Based on lessons from past activations, the following changes were made to the present framework iteration:

1. Moved towards phased triggers: readiness trigger, action trigger: this creates more lead time for verification, procurement, pre-positioning, and community engagement.
2. CERF envelope was adjusted to better align with operational lessons: Partner allocations adjusted to reflect delivery experience, and MPCA requires a modest increase.
3. Early warning becomes more actionable: Warning is shifting from information-sharing to practical risk communication. Communities need clear guidance on what to do, when, where and with whose support.
4. Improved targeting: targeting will combine social register data, flood exposure, and community validation. A dedicated inter-agency targeting process is established.
5. NHF positioned as complementary to CERF: NHF will use fewer partners and will support readiness, targeting, localization, and multi-purpose cash (MPCA).

Validity period

While the framework itself is not time-bound, the CERF pre-arranged funding, following endorsement by the Emergency Relief Coordinator, will be valid for a two-year period (covering the 2026 and 2027 seasons), with the possibility of extension. NHF funds are expected to be utilized by the end of 2026.

Nigeria is highly prone to climate hazards like floods, storms, ocean surges, droughts and wildfires. Due to climate change, flood risks are expected to increase even further through more frequent and intense rainfall.¹ The 2024 floods inundated 34 of the 36 states, with Borno State being the worst-affected, impacting three million people and leading to a loss of nearly 700 lives and further displacing around 896,000 people. Flood water was estimated to have destroyed 226,000 homes, critical infrastructure and 1.3 million hectares of farmland, causing the loss of 1.1 million tons of maize, sorghum and rice (an estimated \$1 billion in crop losses), enough to feed 13 million people. The disaster also precipitated a severe nationwide cholera outbreak. A staggering 46 per cent of IDP sites are in congested flood-prone areas. By mid-October 2024, more than 14,000 suspected cases and 378 deaths had been recorded, mainly in Borno, Adamawa, Jigawa, Yobe and Kano. In 2025, floods affected more than 400,000 people in 25 States across Nigeria, with 232 people losing their lives.²



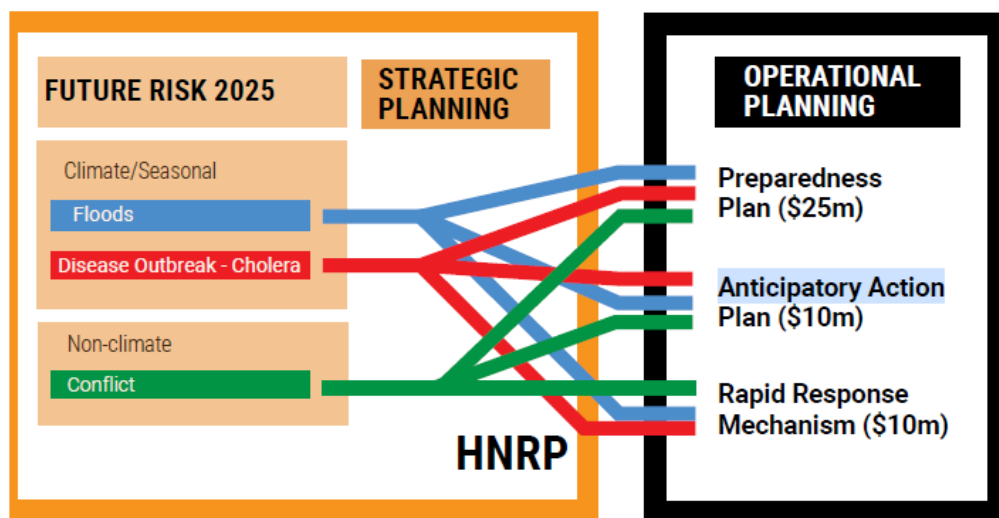
AA is a collective undertaking. Participating partners are committing internal resources for all preparedness activities and leveraging their economies of scale in terms of staff, warehousing and other supply chain capacities, on the backs of which anticipatory assistance will be delivered. In addition, WFP has matched the **US\$2 million** allocated to it for multipurpose cash assistance, further strengthening the resources available for early action.

The Government of Nigeria's planned investment demonstrates proactive humanitarian leadership, establishing a regional benchmark for anticipatory disaster response. This commitment was catalyzed by humanitarian partners' sustained practical advocacy, including facilitating national dialogues, embedding AA in strategic

² Nigeria - Floods Anticipatory Action Framework Update: Situation Report 2 (15-22 September 2025) | OCHA

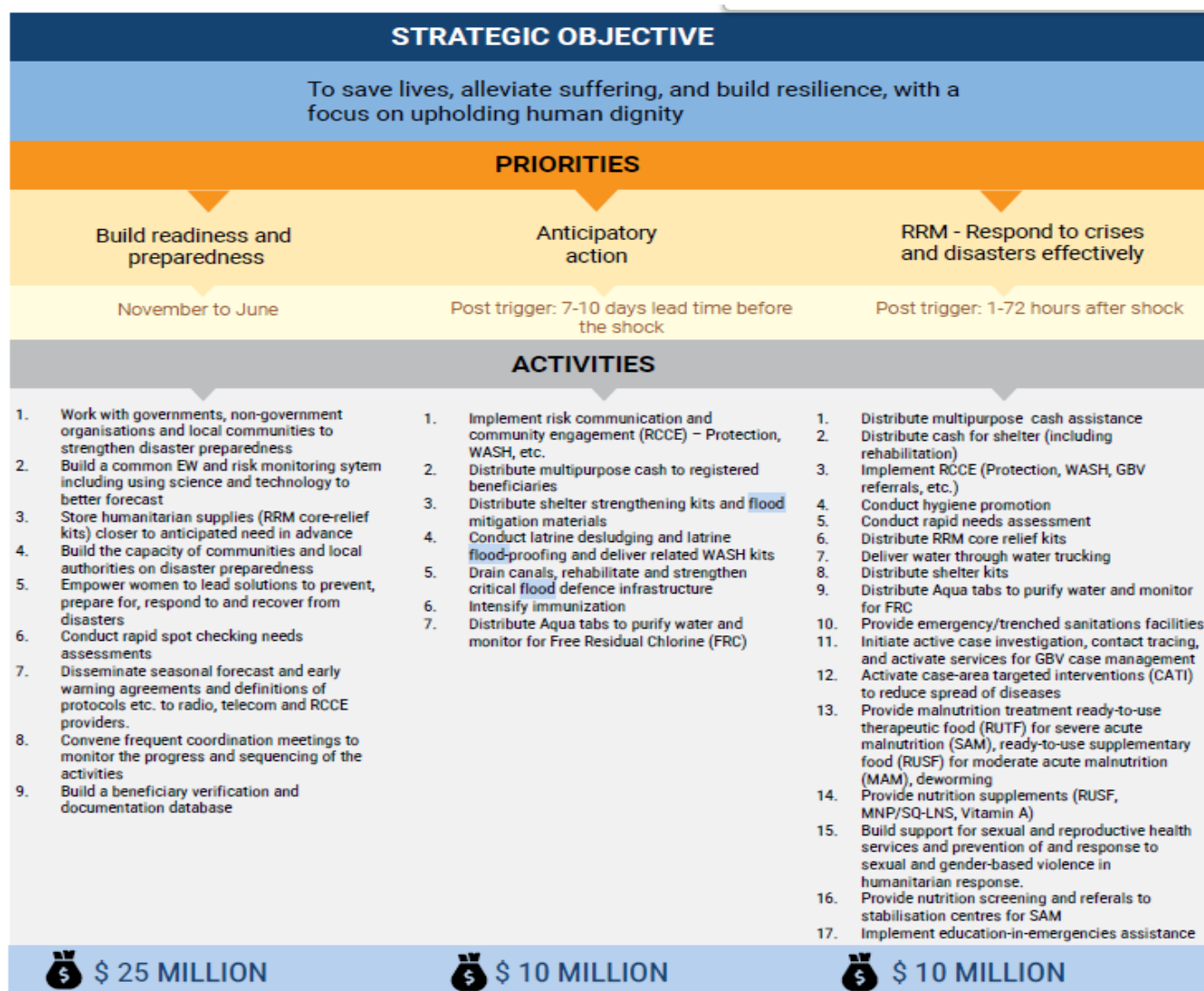
humanitarian plans, and successfully demonstrating anticipatory interventions through CERF and NHF seed funding and partner specific pilots and AA financing. The Government's planned investments are expected to prioritize national organizations, including government agencies and the Nigerian Red Cross, ensuring sustainable, localized proactive assistance. OCHA will support robust coordination, comprehensive activity planning, vulnerability analyses and prioritization, trigger development, and transparent monitoring to support the successful launch of this nationally driven initiative.

Anticipatory action for floods directly advances [Nigeria's draft National Adaptation Plan Framework \(2020\)](#) by strengthening early-warning systems, mainstreaming climate risk into sectoral planning and protecting livelihoods before losses occur. The NAP calls for "coherent approaches to fund mobilization" and "institutional arrangements for inclusive participation", both realized through this coordinated AA framework and the Government's upcoming national AA framework for flood, that ties Government financing to common triggers, shared vulnerability data and national delivery partners. Nigeria's NAP, which was validated in 2025, provides the policy anchor for integrating AA into national adaptation priorities.



Source: Nigeria 2025 HNRP

This framework further draws on the HNRP Strategy for 2024-2025, which outlined steps towards reforming the humanitarian response to achieve greater efficiency. A third element of reform is moving from a reactive to a proactive response, through anticipatory action to humanitarian events. Five per cent of the programmed resources in the 2026 HNRP are intended to address cyclical events such as floods. This is a pioneering step in humanitarian response planning where AA resource needs for predictable shocks are articulated at the strategic planning moment, while inter-sector priorities articulate at-risk areas; project and quantify the impact; identify the time when risks converge; and outline appropriate modalities and sector-specific activities to address these risks/future shocks.



Source: Nigeria 2025 HNRP

The framework draws on partners' previous anticipatory action investments, pilots and programmes. Specifically, it draws on lessons from the 2025 framework activation. The activation in Adamawa State demonstrated that Nigeria's anticipatory action system can successfully translate forecast information into early humanitarian action when triggers, financing, coordination, and implementation mechanisms are aligned. Early warning messages reached communities ahead of peak flooding, and multipurpose cash assistance was delivered rapidly following trigger activation, contributing to improved food security, reduced use of negative coping strategies, and greater household resilience during the flood period. The activation also highlighted several areas for improvement. While institutional stakeholders generally viewed the trigger and activation process as timely, many community members perceived assistance as arriving too close to, or after, the onset of flood impacts, particularly in areas affected by rapid-onset flash flooding. Key lessons included the need to strengthen trigger sensitivity and flexibility through phased or multi-layered activation approaches, improve targeting systems and social registry data to reduce exclusion errors, expand community-centred early warning and risk communication, and increase preparedness investments such as pre-positioning, beneficiary verification, and readiness financing.

The framework also builds on the NHF allocation in 2024 (\$2m), which was based on a no-regrets strategy for readiness, anticipatory action and early response for riverine floods, flash floods and cholera risks in two of the 774 LGAs in Nigeria – Bama (Borno) and Numan (Adamawa). Approximately 276,600 people were estimated to be exposed to the aforementioned risks. While the allocation process was underway, the large-scale floods, associated with dam-break, occurred and the proactive allocation served as a catalyst for early response.

The framework builds on Nigeria's expanding anticipatory action ecosystem, including partner-led initiatives by NRCS/IFRC, Save the Children, IRC, Welthungerhilfe/Oxfam through the WAHAFA Facility, and others. For this framework iteration, the focus is on stronger alignment and complementarity across these efforts.

Where partners have existing protocols or trigger-based plans, the framework will seek to align forecasting sources, trigger monitoring, early warning, targeting, implementation timelines and delivery modalities. Global tools such as GloFAS will be used alongside national data and validation from NiHSA and NiMet, helping to strengthen consistency between technical analysis and operational decision-making.

The framework does not replace partner protocols. It provides a common coordination platform to support a more coherent, government-led approach, especially in riverine flood-risk areas along the Benue and Niger river systems and in selected locations where flash-flood approaches will be piloted.

This framework's priority is to reduce fragmentation and ensure partners align around common risk analysis, agreed triggers, harmonised targeting, coordinated early warning, centralised feedback and clear geographic and sectoral responsibilities. Partners will also leverage their own preparedness investments, staff presence, warehousing, supply chains and community networks to support faster and more coherent anticipatory action once triggers are reached.

5. Triggers, Activation Protocol and Geographic Focus

Triggers

The trigger mechanism for the framework was developed by the triggers sub-working group, chaired by Nigerian Government partners, including the following agencies:

- Nigeria Hydrological Services Agency (NiHSA)
- Nigerian Meteorological Agency (NiMet)
- National Emergency Management Agency (NEMA)
- National Space Research and Development Agency (NASRDA)
- OCHA Centre for Humanitarian Data

Historical data from NiHSA and NEMA were used to validate all triggers.

The trigger mechanism for this framework includes two separate triggers which can be activated independently:

3. **Riverine flooding trigger [action and readiness]:** used to release CERF *and* NHF funding to implement activities in the 7 LGAs along the Benue River in Adamawa state (Fufure, Yola South, Yola North, Girei, Demsa, Numan, and Lamurde).
4. **Flash flooding observational trigger:** used to release *only* NHF funding, as a reprogramming /secondary option, to implement activities in the 4 additional flash-flooding LGAs in the BAY states (Mobbar, Maiduguri, Geidam, Jere)

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As occurred in 2012 and 2018, **it is possible that the readiness trigger is not met in advance of the action trigger**.

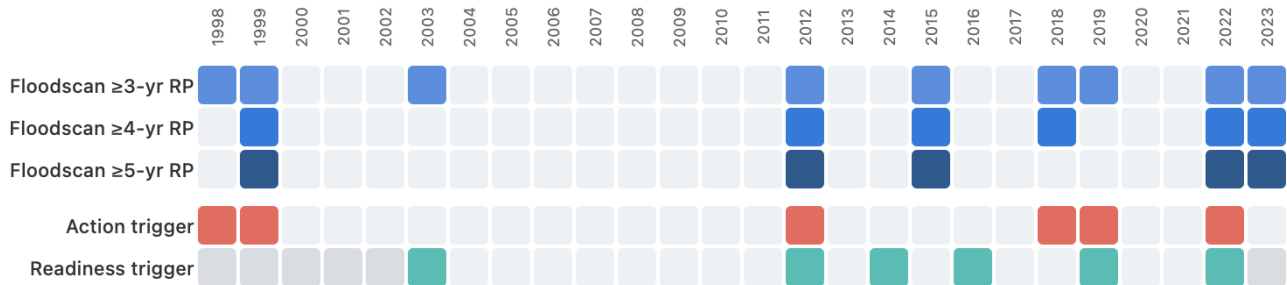
If the readiness trigger is activated, *only* the readiness activities are to be implemented, and only the fraction of funding for these activities is authorized to be spent.

1.2 Action Trigger

The action trigger is activated if at least 6 of 10 selected Google GRRR gauge stations along the Benue simultaneously exceed their individual 4-year return period thresholds (~1,100–1,117 m³/s per gauge) on the same day. These 10 gauges were selected from the full set of 42 available GloFAS and Google gauges, as those

with the highest performance in detecting historical flood events. See the appendix for a summary of all thresholds per gauge.

The overall return period of the action trigger is approximately 1-in-4.5 years. Operationally, the trigger is expected to fire up to 5 days before a 1-in-4 year flood event. The heatmap below provides further details, indicating the years of historical events and past activations. Note that the Google reanalysis data is used for historical analysis, given the limited availability of reforecast data and the very high skill of the forecast.



The riverine trigger mechanism historical accuracy statistics are shown in the table below. Both triggers are evaluated against the 4-year return period Floodscan indicator.

Trigger Mechanism Statistics

Stats by trigger

Analysis years: 1998-2023 (action), 2003-2022 (readiness)

Trigger	Return period	Activation probability	Years activated
Readiness	3.5 years	29%	2003, 2012, 2014, 2016, 2019, 2022
Action	4.5 years	22%	1998, 1999, 2012, 2018, 2019, 2022

Overall stats

Analysis years: 2003-2022

Overall return period	3.0 years	Average period for total budget spend / Effective return period	4.1 years
Overall probability of activation	33%	Probability of total budget spend	24%
Average total spending per year	\$1.0M	Average total spending per year with activation	\$2.9M

2. Flash flooding trigger (monitoring only)

This framework will also monitor flash flooding to inform reprogramming options for the NHF and other partner-specific early/rapid response mobilization. It will be triggered if: The flood exposure (calculated by overlaying the satellite flood extent³ with the population distribution⁴) for an LGA exceeds its corresponding threshold, listed below:

- Mobbar: 14,720 people
- Maiduguri: 23,740 people
- Geidam: 5,501 people
- Jere: 103,612 people

Note that due to biases in the flood extent data between geographies, these values do not correspond directly to the number of people impacted and should only be compared to other values from the same LGA. Furthermore,

³ Measured using the Floodscan SFED product aer.powerserve.net/weather-risk-management/floodscan-near-real-time-and-historical-flood-mapping

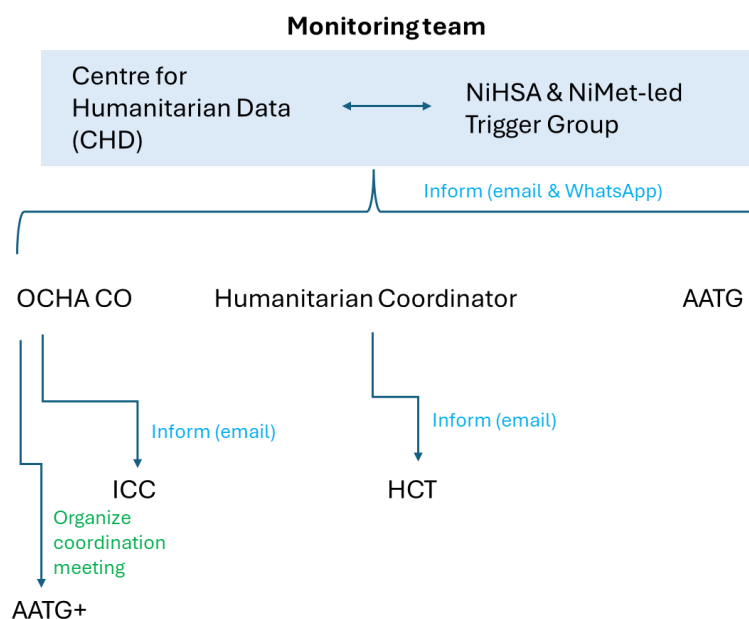
the levels have been set to give an equal probability of triggering in each LGA, with an overall return period of approximately 4 years.

Activation protocol – riverine flooding

When	Who	What	How
Monitoring period: June to end of December	OCHA Center for Humanitarian Data (CHD)	Monitors flood forecasts (GloFAS and Google FloodHub), supported by data from government agencies	Automated daily monitoring emails to all partners of the AA framework
Ahead of triggers being met	Partners	Implement preparedness activities (NHF-partners using NHF funds allocated for preparedness)	As per the framework
Readiness trigger			
When readiness trigger is reached	OCHA Center for Humanitarian Data (CHD)	Informs the RC/HC, CERF, NHF, Core AA Working Group partners, NEMA, NiHSA and NiMet	Automated email WhatsApp group used to facilitate communication
When readiness trigger is reached	CERF	Immediately sends approval letters to the agencies upon notification that the readiness trigger is reached	Pre-approved CERF/NHF approval letter, sent by email
After CERF has sent approval letters	Partners	Begin implementing readiness activities only	As per the framework
As applicable, after the readiness or action trigger is reached	NiHSA, NiMet, NEMA, or RC/HC (or OCHA on behalf of the HCT)	May call a meeting with the Core AA Working Group representatives, the NHF fund manager and HCT members to discuss the situation, including coordination of actions with government efforts. This meeting is not to discuss whether the framework should be activated.	Meeting
Action trigger			
When the action trigger is reached	OCHA Center for Humanitarian Data (CHD)	Informs the RC/HC, CERF/NHF, Core AA Working Group partners, NEMA, NiHSA and NiMet.	Automated email WhatsApp group used to facilitate communication
When the activation is confirmed	CERF NHF	If no previous readiness trigger: sends approval letters to the agencies If after previous readiness trigger: confirms to agencies that they are authorized to use the readiness and action portion of the funding envelope Fund manager informs NHF partners they are authorized to use action portion of the funding envelope	Email

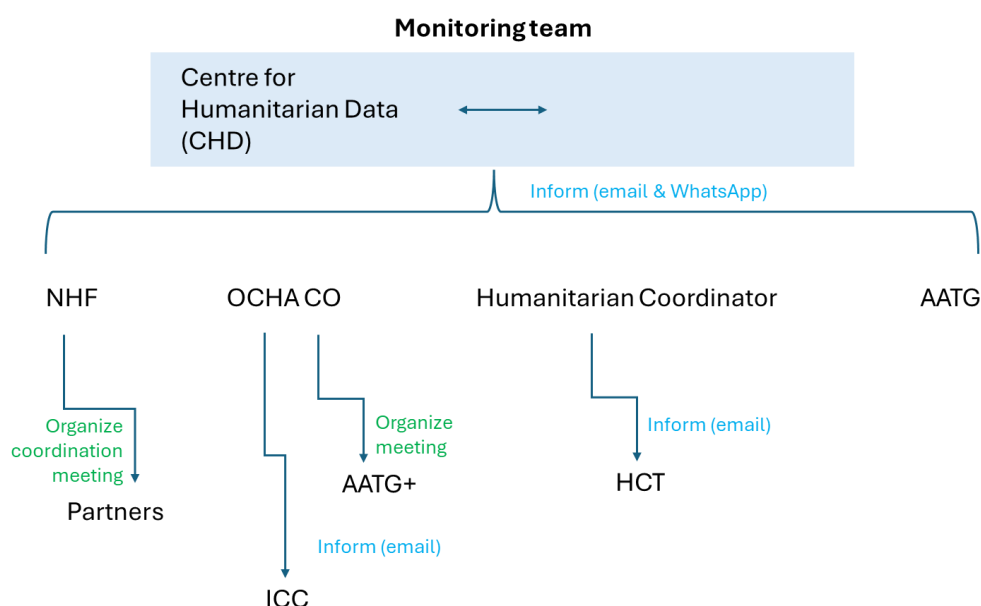
When	Who	What	How
After CERF/NHF have sent approval letters or confirmed authorization to use funds	Partners	Begin implementing activities	As per the framework

The monitoring protocol is summarized below:



Monitoring protocol – flash flooding

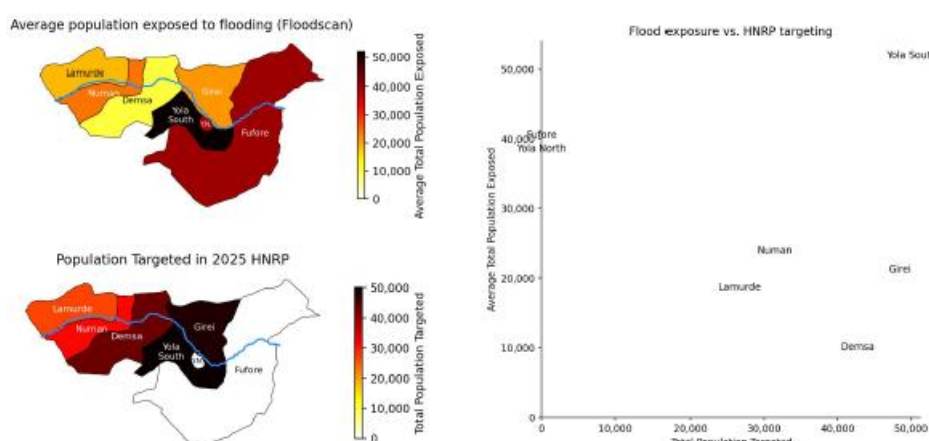
OCHA (Centre for Humanitarian Data), in collaboration with the government (NiHSA and NiMet), will monitor the flood exposure and will notify key stakeholders if the threshold is surpassed in any LGA, including the Nigeria Humanitarian Fund (NHF), OCHA Nigeria Country Office, the Humanitarian Coordinator and the Anticipatory Action Technical Group (AATG).



Partners of the NHF are the main implementing actors, should the flash flooding trigger be reached. In case of an activation, they will be notified in real time by the NHF fund manager, who will also organize a coordination meeting to ensure partners' readiness in affected areas.

Geographical Focus

Riverine Floods:



The geographical selection for the AA framework followed a four-tiered approach:

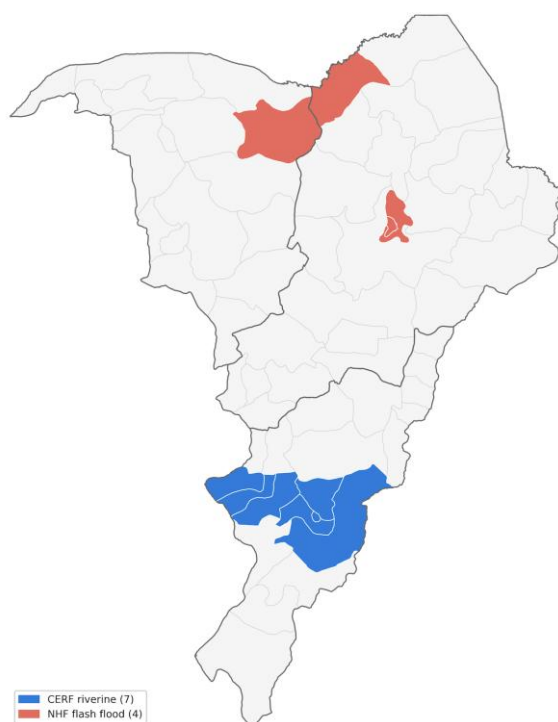
- 1) analysis of historic data of observed floods and impacts (based on NiHSA and NiMet data).
- 2) analysis of historical flood risk (based on NEMA data).
- 3) analysis of historic average population exposed to floods (based on FloodScan); and
- 4) severity of needs based on the 2025 HNRP People in Need (PiN) figures

Based on this analysis and consultations with humanitarian and Government partners and an evaluation of achievable AA investments with aim to maximize impact of the limited AA pre-arranged funding, AA Group partners have prioritized 7 LGAs in Adamawa State prone to riverine flooding – Fufore, Yola South, Yola North, Girei, Demsa, Numan, and Lamurde (in blue on the map).

Flash Floods:

The reprogramming option reserved for NHF funds and early/rapid response mechanisms through other funding sources prioritizes LGAs at risk of flash flooding and not along the Benue River (covered by the CERF+NHF riverine flooding pre-arranged financing).

These locations were selected based on the NiHSA 2026 projections for communities at risk of flooding, as well as the 2026 HNRP prioritized LGAs. This selection prioritizes locations with greater concentrations of “high” and “medium” flood risk communities. These LGAs include Mobbar, Maiduguri, Geidam, and Jere, and are depicted in red in the image seen here. For comparison purposes only, the LGAs along the Benue River identified as at risk of riverine floods are depicted in blue.



Household Targeting

Core AA Group partners agreed to apply a coordinated and transparent household targeting approach that combines **geographic flood-risk exposure, vulnerability data from the National Social Registry (NSR), household vulnerability with community-based validation** to ensure that assistance reaches households most at risk and least able to prepare, relocate or recover. Building on the AAR and PDM lessons from last year’s implementation, the framework will place stronger emphasis on early pre-identification, geographic de-duplication, harmonised MPCA transfer values, and clear partner coordination to avoid overlap while improving timeliness and accountability. The NSR, managed through NASSCO, provides a strong basis for identifying poor and vulnerable households, using geographic targeting, community ranking, community-based targeting and proxy means testing, with profiles covering approximately 19 million vulnerable individuals across indicators such as income, food consumption, livelihoods, coping capacity, family composition and other vulnerability categories. Data-sharing arrangements with NASSCO have already been agreed, and a coordinated targeting validation exercise will be undertaken to confirm inclusion and exclusion, verify household vulnerability through community structures, align partner caseloads and ensure that WFP, IOM and LESGO use the common registry, harmonised transfer values and geographic de-duplication before activation. This approach is consistent with the revised framework’s stronger focus on timely, flexible and people-centred early action, particularly through MPCA, while maintaining complementarity with livelihoods, health, WASH/NFI and relocation-site preparedness interventions.

6. Planned Activities

Selection criteria

Anticipatory actions aim to protect those most at risk before a shock fully unfolds. Actions selected followed these criteria:

- **Anticipatory character:** Activities effectively prevent or reduce the humanitarian impact of floods.
- **Feasible within the window of opportunity:** activities can be delivered within the lead time – i.e. between the trigger and the peak impact of flood waters.
- **Operational capacity:** Partners have the necessary institutional (thematic, logistic, administrative, financial, human resources) capacity to implement these activities at scale within the lead time.
- **No regrets approach:** In case of a false alarm, proposed actions benefit (and do not negatively affect) people targeted.

Objectives

The pre-agreed activities aim to mitigate the main humanitarian impacts of floods. They focus on:

- Enabling communities to take informed decisions
- Mitigating loss of lives and household assets
- Safeguarding agricultural production and reducing yield losses
- Mitigating displacement
- Avoiding deteriorating food security and other needs
- Ensuring the availability of safe water for human and animal consumption
- Reducing the risk of disease outbreaks, particularly cholera
- Reducing morbidity and mortality through access to essential goods and services
- Mitigating flood- and displacement-related protection risks (including GBV, family separation, loss of documentation, etc.) and use of negative coping strategies

Activities

An overview of assistance packages that will be delivered by humanitarian partners, funded by CERF and NHF, is shown below. Details on activities and projects can be found in respective project proposals.

Sector	Partner	Budget	Number of people targeted	Trigger	Activities
CERF					
Multisector (MPCA)	WFP	\$2M (+2M WFP co-funding)	199,338	Readiness	• Conduct mapping and community level targeting of potential flood affected locations (at-risk communities) • Enhancing provision of national identity and financial inclusiveness through account opening for flood-exposed populations and families • Update and expansion of the poor and vulnerable households in potential and flood-exposed communities. • Verification and validation of the poor and vulnerable households in the social register, to enhance

					effective targeting of the potential AA beneficiaries • Complete the process of targeting and selection of potential beneficiaries in readiness of MPCA disbursement, upon activation of early actions triggers
				Action	• Disburse Multipurpose cash assistance (MPCA) to vulnerable and at-risk families
Agriculture	FAO	\$500k	441,155	Readiness	• Field assessments & planning (combined) • Community mobilization & beneficiary targeting • Pre-positioning of diversified livestock (commercially sourced concentrate) feed
				Action	• Drainage clearing: Identification of drainage points, validation of sites, targeting, livestock risk profiling (missions, transport, per diems) • Distribution of diversified livestock (commercially sourced concentrate) feed • Distribution of grain and fodder storage materials (bags) • Livestock vaccination
Health	WHO	\$500k	764,864	Readiness	• Pre-agree SMOH rosters, identify closer pre-positioning locations, use the NAFDAC-approved list, strengthen decentralized diagnostics, pre-map community surveillance networks
				Action	• Distribution of insecticide-treated mosquitoes bed nets • Provision of emergency medical supplies, including cholera treatment kits and essential medicines to health facilities and mobile clinic • Rapid deployment of decentralized diagnostic testing at health facilities, mobile clinics, and treatment centers including malaria rapid diagnostic tests and cholera diagnostics

					• Pre-emptive scaling-up of early case detection and referral through strengthened community and LGA level surveillance, leveraging pre-mapped community networks, to enable rapid identification, referral of treatment of suspected cases • Deployment of mobile clinics to serve displaced and hard-to-reach populations • Provide lifesaving minimum initial service package on sexual reproductive health (SRH) • Preposition & deploy SRH surge/mobile teams to provide SRH services • Preposition & distribute interagency reproductive health kit
Multisector (MPCA)	IOM	\$1M	135,371	Readiness	• Verification and validation of the poor and vulnerable households in the social register, to enhance effective targeting of the potential AA beneficiaries • Complete the process of targeting and selection of potential beneficiaries in readiness of MPCA disbursement
				Action	• Disburse Multipurpose cash assistance (MPCA) to vulnerable and at-risk families
Wash	UNICEF	\$1M	764,864	Readiness	• Mapping/identification of safe water points in communities, temporary sanitation areas • Activation of contingency programme documents with partners • Prepositioning of critical WASH supplies in flood- and cholera-prone states, including WASH/cholera/hygiene kits, water treatment supplies, rapid testing kits, and emergency sanitation materials

					• Activate sector-level coordination mechanism • Community engagement (e.g. hygiene promotion, risk communication) including on preparedness actions such as drainage desilting in critical areas • Identification, mapping and preparation of potential evacuation sites and high-risk displacement locations, evacuation planning and displacement-sensitive targeting • Prepositioning of NFI supplies.
				Action	• Rehabilitation and/or maintenance of existing water supply systems, sanitation infrastructure (showers and latrines), including desludging both at potentially affected locations and displacement sites • Rehabilitation of gender segregated latrine blocks • Desludging and distribution of latrine repair kits • Provision of life-saving WASH supplies, Water Purification Tablets (WPTs), Jerrycans for household water treatment and hygiene kits • Provision of household items (NFI kits) • Site management, decongestion and continuity of services for 4 weeks
NHF					
Multi-purpose cash	LESGO	\$500,000	17,445	Readiness/Action	• Verification of target affected population using existing state social register and community validation • Step up of delivery mechanisms (Contracting FSPs, Testing and mapping of transfer modalities e.g. prepaid cards bank transfers etc.)

					• Community sensitization and awareness of AA MPCA, set up feedback and response mechanisms • Conduct/update Joint Market Monitoring Initiative (JMMI) in at-risk areas and ensure critical goods/services are available and accessible pre-flood • Align transfer values with the Minimum Expenditure Basket (MEB)
Coordination and Common services (early warning)	Nigeria RedCross Society (NRCS)	\$300,000	764,864	Readiness/Action	• Agreements with radio, telecom providers • Joint targeting: • Identification and Registration of target population • Dissemination of EW messages for the readiness and action • Risk communication and community engagement • Training at community level of EW messages including GBV, PSEA etc • Early warning, risk communication, community engagement, and AAP
Protection (CP, GBV)	HARAF	\$200,000	764,864	Readiness/Action	• Community-based early warning, protection risk mapping, and referral network • Safe evacuation routes and protection-mainstreamed evacuation/assembly sites • GBV lifesaving referral continuity, women/girls' safety planning, and dignity support package • Child protection rapid identification, family tracing/reunification, and child-friendly support at evacuation sites • Dignity, safety, inclusion, and accountability package linked to cash/NFI distributions

Lessons learned

Based on lessons learned from the 2025 framework activation, partners have made the following adjustments to their programming:

To reduce timing gaps, WFP will prioritise a two-tier activation model, with a preparedness trigger releasing funds for early readiness activities and an action trigger initiating full interventions. This is intended to allow sectoral actions to be implemented within the same operational window.

FAO will improve targeting through updated vulnerability maps and community validation, responding to gaps in beneficiary identification and awareness. It will also strengthen veterinary preparedness by investing in cold-chain and solar-powered equipment, linking animal-health data to community early-warning systems, and improving coordination with waste-management authorities following drainage works.

WHO will planning, procurement and pre-positioning, using strategic LGA hubs, real-time logistics tracking and contingency procurement to reduce supply delays and stock-outs. It will further institutionalise PHEOC-led multisectoral coordination, joint supervision and integrated monitoring, while embedding anticipatory interventions in routine primary healthcare outreach and state emergency-preparedness plans

Building on integrated WASH, health, nutrition and risk-communication delivery, UNICEF is expected to prioritise earlier pre-positioning of essential supplies and tighter joint planning, supervision and monitoring with government and health partners. It should also sustain local-language, two-way community engagement and accessible feedback mechanisms to strengthen preparedness, inclusion and accountability.

Joint Approach to Targeting and to Early Warning

AA partners agreed to apply a coordinated approach that links joint household targeting with harmonised early warning and community engagement. To ensure consistency, avoid mixed messages and support timely anticipatory action, a single agency will disseminate early warning messages on behalf of all implementing partners. Given its community presence, access and geographic reach, the **Nigerian Red Cross Society**, supported through NHF funding, will lead early warning messaging and dissemination for AA partners. This will be done in close coordination with the National Orientation Agency, which will support Government-led public communication through established channels, including radio, television and other community outreach platforms. This approach reflects lessons from last year's implementation by strengthening coordination, ensuring communities receive clear and trusted messages, and linking early warning directly to targeting, preparedness and trigger-based assistance.

7. Pre-agreed Financing

Complementarity between pooled funds

CERF and NHF funding will be complementary.

1. CERF will provide funding to UN agencies focusing on Food Security (incl. agriculture), WASH, Health and Shelter-NFI, underpinned by MPCA.
2. NHF funding will focus on common services such as early warning and joint targeting, child protection and GBV, underpinned by MPCA. In case the primary riverine flooding trigger does not get reached (Scenario 1), resources may be pivoted to flash floods (Scenario 2) or broader reprogramming (Scenario 3). Furthermore, the NHF will leverage its comparative advantage to have an exclusive partnership with national NGOs.

Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF)

For this anticipatory action framework in Nigeria, the ERC has pre-agreed to allocate *up to \$5 million* from the CERF only if triggers for riverine flooding are reached within the specified season and duration.

CERF will disburse funds once three conditions are met:

- Endorsement by the Humanitarian Coordinator of the framework and the CERF application package, including agency project proposals and budgets; and
- Endorsement by the Emergency Relief Coordinator of the finalized framework, as well as the CERF agency project proposals and budgets; and
- Crossing trigger thresholds of the framework once fully approved and operational.

CERF will disburse funds on a no-regrets basis as soon as either the readiness trigger or the action trigger is reached. While a portion of the funds can be used immediately upon disbursement for readiness activities, the remaining portion of the funding can only be used if and when an action trigger is met. The amount of funding for readiness vs action activities will be clearly defined in the pre-approved project proposals and budgets. The need to distinguish between these two cost categories in advance is important given the different potential scenarios:

- Scenario A: all-systems go (readiness trigger followed a few days later by an action trigger)
- Scenario B: false alarm (readiness trigger, but no action trigger)

- Scenario B-2: false alarm, followed by readiness + action trigger within a maximum of 6 months
- Scenario C: action trigger, but no readiness trigger.
- Scenario D: no activation at all

Upon activation of the framework, CERF will send out approval letters to the relevant agencies and subsequently will disburse all the funds⁶. If the trigger thresholds are not crossed, the pre-arranged funds cannot be transferred for other purposes. The funds remain pre-arranged for the following year (up until the end of the 2-year validity period of the pre-arranged funding). Further details can be found in the CERF project documents and CERF communications. The CERF secretariat must approve any changes to the projects and budgets as per usual practice.

Note: Having an anticipatory action framework supported by CERF does not preclude the RC/HC or HCT from seeking additional CERF Rapid Response funding for the same or other shocks that may be experienced. At the same time, it does not guarantee it either.

Nigeria Humanitarian Fund (NHF)

The NHF is pioneering an anticipatory approach for floods, complementing CERF's focus and pre-arranging \$1m for common services and multi-sectoral response under different scenarios. A reserve allocation was launched and approved by the Advisory Board with pre-vetted partners based on inter-sector consultations, as per usual reserve allocation practices.

The NHF will disburse the first tranche by the end of July (the exact amount to be confirmed), with the remaining funds to be disbursed upon activation of the riverine trigger, should the threshold be met. This will cover the same seven LGAs identified for CERF-financed activities: Fufere, Yola South, Yola North, Girei, Demsa, Numan, and Lamurde. Upon submission of project proposals, pre-identified partners will implement activities in the sectors of Common services such as early warning and joint targeting, child protection and GBV, and MPCA. The envelope distribution per sector is below:

Joint targeting and Early Warning	Protection (child protection & GBV)	Multisectoral (MPCA)
\$300,000	\$200,000	\$500,000

While implementing anticipatory actions ahead of the impact of riverine flooding is the primary objective of the NHF reserve allocation, considerations have been made should the riverine flood trigger not be activated. Such a scenario would enable partners to implement early response activities to the impact of flash floods on the most affected communities or reprogramme the funding for other priorities. The different scenarios are outlined below:

#	Description	Sectors	Envelope
Scenario 1	If the riverine flooding trigger is reached, all NHF funds will be allocated to implement anticipatory activities in the 7 pre-identified LGAs, in complementarity with CERF	Common services Protection MPCA	\$1,000,000 (riverine floods – anticipatory action)
Scenario 2	If the riverine flooding trigger is not reached by the end of peak riverine flood season (around mid-September), but the flash floods trigger is met, all NHF funds will be allocated to implement early response activities in LGAs where the flash flood trigger is activated based on observational data	Common services Protection MPCA	TBD (flash floods – early response)
3	If neither the flash flood nor the riverine flooding triggers are activated, NHF funding will be reprogrammed for prioritised response.	TBD	TBD (reprioritized)

Funding source	Partner	Sector	Funding	Agency co-funding -	- Total funding per agency
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⁶ While approval letters will be sent out immediately following an activation, the administrative transfer of funds to agencies may be delayed by a few days. To avoid a delay in project implementation, agencies confirm their ability to frontload the resources required to initiate their response until the funding has been received.

CERF	WFP	Multi-purpose cash	\$2,000,000	\$2,000,000
	IOM	Shelter/NFI	\$1,000,000	
	UNICEF	WASH	\$1,000,000	
	WHO	Health	\$500,000	
	FAO	Food Security - Agriculture	\$500,000	
	TOTAL CERF		\$5,000,000	
NHF	LESGO	Multi-purpose cash	\$500,000	
	NRCS	Coordination and Common services (early warning)	\$300,000	
	HARAF	Protection (CP, GBV)	\$200,000	
	TOTAL NHF		\$1,000,000	
TOTAL				\$8,000,000

8. Learning, Monitoring and evaluation

This framework offers significant opportunities to both generate and apply learning, thus contributing to the overall improvement of humanitarian action in response to sudden-onset shocks.

Each agency will use its existing monitoring & evaluation systems to collect and track data on implementation progress and outputs achieved. All reports and findings will be shared. In case a joint evaluation is conducted, all UN agencies receiving CERF funding agreed to share data on targeted people, within existing regulations, and committed to providing relevant inputs to support the evaluation. Furthermore, it was agreed that lessons learning will be facilitated through after action or peer reviews, with findings shared and discussed among stakeholders involved.

Based on lessons from past activations, the following changes were made to the present framework iteration:

1. Moved towards phased triggers: readiness trigger, action trigger: this creates more lead time for verification, procurement, pre-positioning, and community engagement.
2. CERF envelope was adjusted to better align with operational lessons: Partner allocations adjusted to reflect delivery experience, and MPCA requires a modest increase.
3. Early warning becomes more actionable: Warning is shifting from information-sharing to practical risk communication. Communities need clear guidance on what to do, when, where and with whose support.
4. Improved targeting: targeting will combine social register data, flood exposure, and community validation. A dedicated inter-agency targeting process is established.
5. NHF positioned as complementary to CERF: NHF will use fewer partners and will support readiness, targeting, localization, and multi-purpose cash (MPCA).

9. Validity and future of the framework

The ERC has pre-arranged the CERF funding for a period of two years, initially. Therefore, all provisions and arrangements under the framework, including the pre-arranged funding, will remain in place until mid-2028. NHF funds are expected to be utilized by the end of 2026.

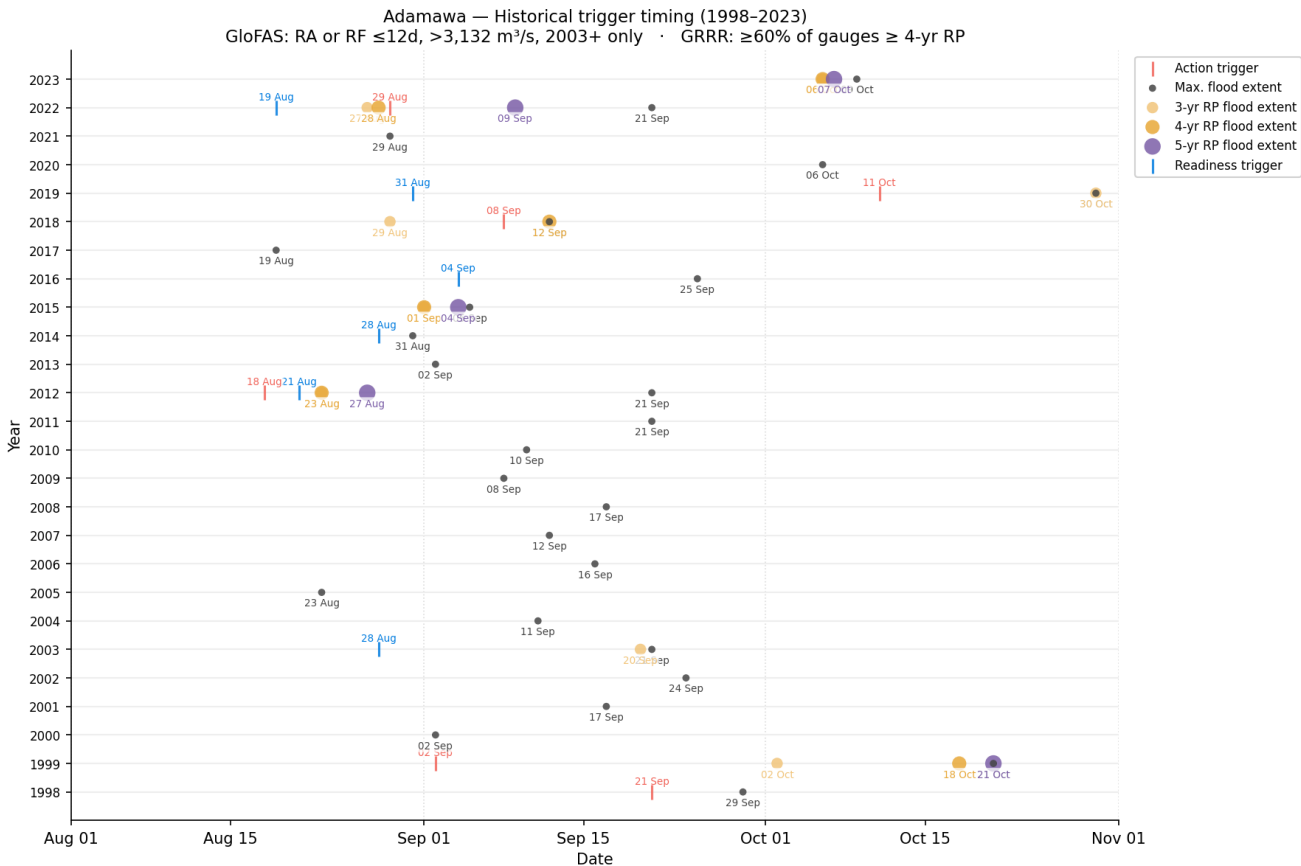
10. Annexes

1. Trigger technical details

The table below summarizes the thresholds for each gauge.

Google Gauge ID	Gauge Attributes	Threshold (m ³ /s)
hybas_1120842990	Along Benue River	1,111
hybas_1120843610	Along Benue River	1,102
hybas_1120845060	Along Benue River	1,102
hybas_1120849600	Along Benue River	1,114
hybas_1120848550	Along Benue River	1,106
hybas_1121970280	Along Benue River	1,110
hybas_1120842550	“High confidence” gauge at Kangli, along Benue River	1,114
hybas_1120840700	Along Benue River	1,113
hybas_1120840560	Along Benue River	1,117
hybas_1120840690	Along smaller tributary	143

The table below shows a full historical record of when the trigger would have been activated. Coloured bubbles indicate when flooding began to occur, at different levels of severity. Note that because the historical forecast data does not cover 2024, it cannot be determined when the framework would have activated in that year. However, based on the reanalysis, it would have activated in 2024 by August 20th at the latest.



* GRRR trigger date is estimated from reanalysis, shifted 5 days earlier to fill gaps in the historical reforecast record, given how strong reforecast skill is at this leadtime

Core principles

Each anticipatory action framework is tailored to the local context. OCHA has identified nine core principles that should apply to the framework in Nigeria:

- **Prioritizing a multi-sectoral approach:** Partners should prioritize multi-sectoral, co-targeted interventions, when possible, to maximize synergies and to achieve great impact.
- **Ensuring the centrality of protection:** In line with the IASC centrality of protection policy, and the principle of “leaving no one behind” (2030 Agenda), all partners implementing anticipatory interventions have the responsibility to ensure that their response will not aggravate the exposure of communities to risks of violence, insecurity, extortion and exploitation. Anticipatory actions must also ensure that they benefit all communities (local communities, displaced communities, returnees, and refugees) based on their needs, with due attention given to obstacles linked to gender, age, disability or social affiliation.
- **Ensuring gender equality is central to inclusive and accountable anticipatory action:** In line with IASC Policy on Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women and Girls in Humanitarian Action, all partners are responsible and accountable to ensure humanitarian action, including anticipatory action is: rights-based; recognizes gender-based and intersectional needs, as well as potential gender-based discrimination in access to resources and services; facilitate leadership and contribution of crisis-affected women and girls in the planning, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of anticipatory actions and early response, that directly impact their lives and those of their dependents and wider communities.
- **Promoting accountability to affected populations and the Protection from Sexual Exploitation and Abuse (PSEA):** Partners engaged in the implementation of the anticipatory framework are responsible for the integration of accountability to affected populations approaches in their activities. This includes making all efforts to solicit, hear, and act upon the voices and priorities of affected people (including the most marginalized and at-risk women, men, girls and boys) in a coordinated manner, before, during, and after anticipatory action. It also means ensuring that community feedback leads to corrective action in future anticipatory action.
- **Supporting localization:** All partners involved in the implementation of this framework are expected to honor HCT’s commitment towards localization. Equitable partnerships with local actors building upon their long-term relationships and trust with communities during anticipatory action are crucial.

- **Engaging in partnerships:** Collaboration across humanitarian actors is key to ensuring that all sectors are engaged, and that assistance is mobilized according to the AA framework.
- **Generating development and climate adaptation co-benefits:** Framework partners are encouraged to consider how financing for anticipatory action can complement financing for development by reducing suffering and addressing the root causes of problems while supporting adaptation to climate change.
- **Capturing learning:** Monitoring, evaluation and learning activities should be embedded at every phase of the development and implementation of the AA framework.
- **Striving for integration:** The framework seeks to integrate the anticipatory action activities into the existing humanitarian architecture and to foster linkages with long term programming, including resilience and development initiatives.

Contact list

****PLACEHOLDER – TO BE INSERTED**